

Course Syllabus: Thesis Writing and Research Methods 1st Semester, A.Y. 2026–2027

Course Information

Instructor: [Research Instructor Name] | Units: 3 | Schedule: F 1:00–4:00 PM | Room: Research Lab

1. Course Description

This course guides fourth-year IS students through the research process from topic conceptualization to final thesis defense. Students will develop skills in research design, literature review writing, data collection methodologies, statistical analysis, and academic writing. By the end of the semester, students will have completed and defended Chapters 1 through 3 of their undergraduate thesis.

2. Learning Outcomes

LO 1: Formulate a clear and researchable problem statement relevant to the field of Information Systems.

LO 2: Conduct a comprehensive review of related literature and synthesize findings.

LO 3: Design an appropriate research methodology including data collection and analysis plans.

LO 4: Write and defend Chapters 1, 2, and 3 of an undergraduate thesis following APA 7th edition format.

3. Chapter and Milestone Schedule

Week	Milestone	Output
1	Orientation; Research Ethics; Topic Brainstorming	Topic Proposal (1 page)
2	Research Problem Identification; Significance of the Study	Define Chapter 1 Section 1
3	Conceptual Framework; Theoretical Framework	Framework Diagram
4	Statement of the Problem; Research Questions; Hypotheses	Write Chapter 1 Draft
5	Literature Review Strategy; Database Search	Annotated Bibliography (10 sources)
6	Synthesizing Related Literature	Literature Matrix
7	Writing Related Studies; Synthesis Paragraph	Draft Chapter 2
8	Midterm Defense: Chapter 1 and Chapter 2	Midterm Defense
9	Research Design; Quantitative vs Qualitative	Methodology Draft
10	Sampling; Population; Data Collection Instruments	Survey/Interview Guide
11	Validity and Reliability; Pilot Testing	Instrument Validation Report

12	Data Collection Plan; Timeline	PT 2: Chapter 3 Draft
13	Statistical Tools; Data Analysis Plan	Analysis Framework
14	Revision of Chapters 1–3 Based on Panel Feedback	Revised Manuscript
15	Pre-Final Defense Rehearsal	Presentation Slides
16	Final Defense: Chapters 1, 2, and 3	Final Thesis Manuscript

4. Grading System

Component	Weight
Chapter Drafts and Revisions	20%
Annotated Bibliography and Literature Matrix	10%
Performance Tasks	20%
Midterm Defense	25%
Final Defense	25%

5. Formatting Guidelines

All written outputs must follow APA 7th Edition formatting: 12pt Times New Roman, double-spaced, 1-inch margins, page numbers on upper right.

Citations: All sources must be properly cited in-text and listed in the References section. Plagiarism will result in automatic disqualification of the submission.

Manuscript Submission: Final thesis manuscript must be submitted both in soft copy (PDF via LMS) and hard copy (spiral-bound) before the defense date.

6. References and Style Guide

1. American Psychological Association. (2020). Publication Manual of the APA (7th ed.).
2. Creswell, J. & Creswell, J.D. (2018). Research Design: Qualitative, Quantitative, and Mixed Methods Approaches. SAGE.
3. Creswell, J. (2015). Educational Research: Planning, Conducting, and Evaluating Quantitative and Qualitative Research. Pearson.